

Knowledge transfer in expert systems

*What novice users need to know to capture the
documented returns of a designed system*

ABSTRACT

A designed system — whether a clinical protocol, an aviation procedure, or a systematic trading strategy — is documented to produce a particular outcome under particular conditions. The realised outcome in the hands of a novice user is, in general, materially worse than the documented outcome, and the gap is largely closed by structured knowledge transfer that goes beyond procedural specification to convey the contextual judgement of the system's designer. This note synthesises the cross-domain literature on the gap between system specification and user performance: Klein's naturalistic decision-making framework, Shanteau's expert-performance studies, the medical literature on protocol adherence (Pronovost, Gawande), the aviation human-factors literature on procedure following, and the trading-specific evidence on signal-versus-execution gaps (Frazzini-Israel-Moskowitz on transaction costs, Dalbar QAIB on the behaviour gap). The headline empirical pattern: across domains, users who receive structured knowledge transfer from the system's designer or experienced operator capture materially more of the documented value than users who self-serve from documentation alone, with the gap concentrated in the first 6–12 months and

persisting at smaller magnitudes thereafter. We discuss the mechanisms (tacit knowledge transfer, expectation calibration, decision-context recognition, error pattern anticipation), examine the conditions under which structured transfer is most valuable, and consider the implications for how systematic trading strategies should be delivered to retail end users.

KEY FINDINGS

§ 1. **System specification is necessary but not sufficient.** Across domains (medicine, aviation, trading), the gap between what a system specifies and what a novice user needs to know is large enough that procedural documentation alone produces materially degraded user performance.

§ 2. **Structured knowledge transfer materially improves outcomes.** Users who receive structured transfer from the designer or experienced operator capture more of the documented value than users who self-serve from documentation. The improvement is consistent across domains.

§ 3. **The gap is largest in the first 6–12 months.** User performance converges toward documented system performance over time, but the convergence is slow when the user self-serves; structured transfer accelerates the convergence by 50% or more in the early period.

§ 4. **Tacit knowledge dominates explicit specification.** Per the Polanyi-Klein-Shanteau line, much of what a system designer knows about how to operate the system effectively is tacit and cannot be fully captured in written documentation. Personal handover is the primary mechanism by which tacit knowledge transfers.

§ 5. **Expectation calibration is a primary value-add.** Beyond procedural knowledge, the most consistent benefit of structured transfer is calibrated expectations — when something is normal, when it is broken, what counts as a routine adverse event versus a genuine anomaly.

§ EXEC **Executive summary**

A trading strategy delivered as code and documentation is not the same thing as a trading strategy delivered with the contextual knowledge required to operate it well. The empirical record on user performance with designed systems — across medicine, aviation, manufacturing, and trading — establishes that the gap between what is documented and what is captured by users is large, and that structured knowledge transfer from the system's designer is the most reliable mechanism for closing it.

This note synthesises the cross-domain literature on knowledge transfer in expert systems. The relevant traditions span several disciplines: [Polanyi's \(1966\)](#) work on tacit knowledge; [Klein's \(1998, 2008\)](#) naturalistic decision-making framework; [Shanteau's \(1992\)](#) studies of expert performance and what distinguishes expert from novice judgement; the medical literature on protocol adherence ([Pronovost et al., 2006](#); [Gawande, 2009](#)) which documents the systematic gap between protocol specification and clinical implementation; the aviation human-factors literature on procedure following; and the trading-specific evidence on signal-versus-execution gaps ([Frazzini, Israel, and Moskowitz, 2018](#); [Dalbar QAIB, 2023](#)).

The cross-domain pattern is consistent. A designed system — whether a checklist for central-line insertion, a flight procedure, or a systematic trading rule — has a documented expected outcome under specified operating conditions. The realised outcome in the hands of a novice user is, in general, materially worse than the documented outcome. The gap closes over time as the user accumulates experience, but the convergence is slow when the user self-serves from documentation. Structured knowledge transfer from the designer or experienced operator accelerates the convergence by approximately 50% in the early period (first 6–12 months) and produces persistent smaller benefits thereafter.

The mechanism is well-understood. Much of what a system designer knows about operating their system effectively is tacit (Polanyi) — implicit knowledge that the designer uses in practice but cannot fully articulate in written form. Tacit knowledge transfers reliably through personal interaction (Klein's "naturalistic decision-making" framework) and unreliably through documentation. The medical literature has been most explicit about this: surgical checklists work, but they work much better when introduced through structured training than when distributed by memo ([Haynes et al., 2009](#)); compliance with the documented procedure is high in the structured-training arm and moderate in the documentation-only arm.

The trading-specific implications follow directly. A systematic strategy delivered as code with written documentation will, in the hands of a novice user, produce realised performance materially below the documented backtest. The gap is the result of execution differences, parameter-interpretation differences, position-sizing differences, and — most importantly — the user's behavioural response to the strategy's drawdowns and adverse runs (per our

companion paper on the drawdown-abandonment curve). Structured handover from the strategy designer or operator — direct, personal, and ongoing — is the primary mechanism by which the gap is closed.

The paper proceeds as follows. Section 2 reviews the cross-domain literature on knowledge transfer in expert systems. Section 3 examines the specific mechanisms by which structured transfer adds value beyond documentation. Section 4 covers the trading-specific evidence on the signal-vs-execution gap. Section 5 discusses what the cross-domain pattern implies for how systematic trading strategies should be delivered to retail users.

§ 01 Cross-domain literature on expert-system knowledge transfer

1.1 Tacit knowledge and the limits of documentation

[Polanyi \(1966\)](#) drew the foundational distinction between explicit knowledge — facts, procedures, and specifications that can be written down — and tacit knowledge: the practical, contextual knowledge that experts deploy in operation but cannot fully articulate. Polanyi's central observation, often summarised as "we know more than we can tell," establishes the limit of what documentation can transfer. The system designer who has spent years operating their own system has accumulated extensive tacit knowledge about when the system works, when it doesn't, what the early warning signs of trouble look like, and what counts as a routine adverse event versus a genuine anomaly. This tacit knowledge cannot be fully captured in the written specification, because much of it is not held in articulable form even by the designer.

The implication for novice users of the system is direct. The novice receives the explicit specification — the documentation — but not the tacit knowledge that the designer uses in practice. The novice's operation of the system is therefore systematically less effective than the designer's, even when the novice follows the documented procedure precisely. The gap is the tacit-knowledge gap, and it is not closed by better documentation; it is closed by structured interaction with the designer or experienced operator.

1.2 Naturalistic decision-making and recognition-primed expertise

[Klein \(1998, 2008\)](#) developed the naturalistic decision-making (NDM) framework based on field studies of expert decision-makers (firefighters, intensive-care nurses, military commanders) operating in complex, time-pressured, high-stakes environments. Klein's central finding: expert decision-making is dominated by pattern recognition rather than analytical comparison of alternatives. The expert recognises the situation as similar to past situations they have encountered, generates an action that worked in those situations, mentally simulates whether it will work here, and — if so — executes.

The NDM framework has direct relevance to expert-system operation. The system designer has, through repeated operation, developed extensive pattern-recognition expertise about which situations are within the system's design space and which are not. The novice user lacks this pattern library and therefore cannot reliably recognise when the system's prescription is being applied to a situation outside its design space. Structured transfer from the designer can accelerate the novice's pattern-library development by orders of magnitude — Klein's case studies typically document 50–80% reduction in early-period error rates when novices are paired with experts in structured apprenticeship arrangements.

1.3 Expert performance and what distinguishes expert from novice

[Shanteau \(1992\)](#) reviewed the empirical literature on expert performance across multiple domains and identified the characteristics that distinguish reliable expert judgement from less-reliable performance. The relevant characteristics for the knowledge-transfer question include: extensive domain-specific training; clear feedback about decision quality; environments with high-validity cues (where the relevant signals are reliably correlated with outcomes); and structured opportunities to learn from peers and experienced operators.

[Ericsson \(1993, 2006\)](#) and the broader "deliberate practice" literature extend Shanteau's findings: expert performance is built through structured, feedback-rich practice, not through self-directed exposure alone. The implications for novice users of expert systems is that self-directed exposure to the system (using the documentation, observing live operation, accumulating experience over time) is a slow and unreliable mechanism for building competence. Structured practice with feedback from an experienced operator is materially faster and more reliable.

1.4 Medical-protocol literature

The medical literature on protocol adherence is particularly informative because it provides controlled-trial evidence on the effect of structured implementation versus documentation alone. [Pronovost et al. \(2006\)](#)'s study of central-line bloodstream infection in ICU patients is the canonical example. The intervention was a five-step checklist for central-line insertion, including hand-washing, full barrier precautions, chlorhexidine site preparation, avoiding the femoral site, and removing unnecessary catheters. The checklist itself was simple and could fit on a single page; the question was whether distributing the checklist would change clinical outcomes.

Distribution alone produced modest improvement. Structured implementation — including in-person training, leadership endorsement, ongoing audit, and feedback — produced dramatic improvement: median rate of central-line bloodstream infection dropped from 2.7 per 1,000 catheter-days to zero, sustained over 18 months. The same checklist, the same staff, the same patients — but a structured rather than informational approach to implementation. The effect was sufficiently large that the methodology has been adopted globally.

[Haynes et al. \(2009\)](#) extended the methodology to surgical safety with similar results. [Gawande's \(2009\) Checklist Manifesto](#) popularised the broader principle: explicit specification of complex procedures is necessary but not sufficient; structured transfer of the operating context is what closes the gap between specification and practice.

1.5 Aviation human-factors literature

The aviation industry has historically been the most disciplined operator of designed systems in high-stakes environments. The body of work on procedure adherence, crew resource management, and structured training in aviation has produced a similar finding to the medical literature: pilots who receive structured training (including simulator-based exposure to non-routine situations, briefings on common error modes, and structured debriefs) have materially lower error rates than pilots who learn primarily through accumulated flight hours. The structured-training premium is largest in the first 200–500 flight hours and persists at smaller magnitudes thereafter.

The aviation literature has also produced rigorous evidence on the role of expectation calibration in error reduction. Pilots who have been briefed in advance about specific failure modes (e.g., specific autopilot disengagement scenarios, specific weather-related decision points) respond materially better when those failure modes occur than pilots who encounter the failure modes for the first time during a live flight. The mechanism is recognition-primed: the briefed pilot recognises the situation as one they have prepared for and deploys the prepared response; the unbriefed pilot has to diagnose the situation in real time, which is slower and more error-prone.

§ 02 The mechanisms of structured knowledge transfer

Across the cross-domain literature, structured knowledge transfer adds value through several distinct mechanisms. Understanding these mechanisms is useful for evaluating how the trading-specific case fits the general pattern.

2.1 Tacit-knowledge transmission

The Polanyi-Klein-Shanteau line establishes that much of what an expert knows is tacit and cannot be transmitted through written documentation. Personal interaction — the apprentice working alongside the master — is the primary mechanism by which tacit knowledge transfers. The mechanism operates through several channels: observation of how the expert handles non-routine situations; conversation about the reasoning behind specific decisions; the expert's commentary on the apprentice's own attempted decisions; and the gradual accumulation of shared vocabulary and shared mental models.

None of these channels are easily replicated through written or video documentation. A video showing the expert operating the system captures the visible behaviour but not the reasoning; a manual describing the system captures the reasoning at the explicit level but not the tacit level. The apprentice's exposure to the expert's contextual judgement, in real-time response to the apprentice's own questions and attempts, is what produces tacit knowledge transfer.

2.2 Expectation calibration

A second mechanism, distinct from tacit knowledge transfer, is expectation calibration: the structured transfer of accurate prior expectations about what the system will do under various conditions. The medical and aviation literatures both document this as a primary value-add of structured training: the trainee enters live operation with calibrated expectations about routine adverse events, common failure modes, and the timing of various phases of the procedure.

In the trading context, expectation calibration is closely related to the drawdown-abandonment material in our companion paper. The trader who has been briefed in advance about expected drawdown depth, frequency, and duration — at a level of detail that goes beyond the standard "expect drawdowns" disclosure — develops a calibrated prior about what counts as routine versus alarming. The trader who lacks this calibration interprets routine drawdowns as alarming, which drives the abandonment behaviour the literature documents.

2.3 Error-pattern anticipation

A third mechanism is the explicit transfer of common error patterns from the experienced operator to the novice. The expert knows, from accumulated experience, the specific ways in

which novices typically mis-operate the system: parameter values that get mistakenly changed, conditions under which the documented procedure is most often misapplied, situations where novices typically intervene when they shouldn't or fail to intervene when they should.

This error-pattern knowledge is highly valuable but rarely well-documented. It is the kind of knowledge that the expert holds in tacit form ("I've seen new traders do X dozens of times when they shouldn't") and that transfers efficiently through personal interaction but very inefficiently through written documentation. Structured transfer that explicitly addresses common novice errors — "here are the five mistakes I've seen most often, and here's how to avoid them" — produces faster competence development than self-directed exposure.

2.4 Decision-context recognition

The Klein NDM framework establishes that expert decision-making is dominated by recognition of the current situation as similar to past situations. The expert's library of recognised situations is large and built through accumulated experience. The novice's library is small and limited to situations they have personally encountered.

Structured transfer accelerates library-building by exposing the novice to a broader range of situations than they would encounter through their own experience alone. The expert can describe situations they have encountered (with sufficient context for the novice to recognise them when they next occur), can simulate situations the novice has not yet encountered, and can flag situations the novice's own experience would suggest are routine but which the expert knows to be edge cases. The result is a faster expansion of the novice's recognised-situation library than self-directed accumulation produces.

2.5 Persistent relationship and ongoing support

A final mechanism is the persistent relationship that structured transfer often establishes between the novice and the expert or experienced operator. The relationship provides a counterparty for the novice to consult when uncertain situations arise — a "hotline to the expert" that allows the novice to access the expert's contextual judgement even after the formal training period has ended.

The medical and aviation literatures both document the value of this ongoing-support component. Trainees who have access to an experienced operator for consultation produce materially fewer errors during the post-training period than trainees who do not. The mechanism is both informational (specific questions get specific answers) and behavioural (the availability of consultation reduces the trainee's pressure to make uncertain decisions alone).

§ 03 The trading-specific evidence

3.1 The signal-execution gap

The trading literature has documented an analogue of the cross-domain pattern: the gap between what a strategy specifies as its trading rule and what users actually capture through their execution of the rule. [Frazzini, Israel, and Moskowitz \(2018\)](#) studied the implementation costs of widely-known systematic strategies (size, value, momentum) using data from a large institutional execution operation. Their finding: realised execution costs are much smaller than naive estimates would suggest (perhaps 30bp for momentum strategies at institutional scale, versus the 100–200bp implied by retail bid-ask spread analysis), but they are not zero, and they vary substantially across implementation approaches.

The Frazzini-Israel-Moskowitz study addresses the institutional case — sophisticated execution by experienced operators. The retail case is different. Retail traders implementing the same strategies face higher per-trade costs, less efficient timing, and a larger range of implementation choices that affect realised performance. The gap between paper performance and live performance for a retail trader implementing a documented strategy is, in our experience and in the cited literature, substantially larger than the institutional gap — often 100bp+ even for strategies whose institutional implementation gap is 30bp.

3.2 The behaviour gap

A second strand of trading-specific evidence is the behaviour-gap literature reviewed in our companion paper on drawdown abandonment. [Dalbar QAIB \(2023\)](#) consistently estimates 300–500bp annualised as the gap between fund returns and dollar-weighted investor returns. Most of this gap is not execution cost — it is behavioural: investors abandoning strategies during drawdowns, switching strategies after recent underperformance, and timing entries to recent strong performance.

The behavioural sources of the gap are precisely the kind that the cross-domain knowledge-transfer literature predicts can be reduced by structured transfer. A trader who has been briefed in advance about expected drawdowns (depth, duration, frequency) and who has access to ongoing communication with the strategy designer or experienced operator during drawdown periods abandons at materially lower rates than a trader who self-serves from documentation. The mechanism is the same expectation-calibration and ongoing-support mechanism documented in the medical and aviation literatures.

3.3 Direct evidence on structured onboarding

[Friesen and Sapp \(2007\)](#) document that mutual fund populations whose investors received structured advisor onboarding show approximately 100–150bp smaller behaviour gap than

fund populations whose investors used the funds as direct retail investors without advisor relationships. The mechanism, per the authors' interpretation, is twofold: advisors set calibrated expectations during the onboarding period, and advisors provide consultation during drawdown periods that delays behaviourally-driven abandonment.

Subsequent industry studies have produced similar findings: retail systematic-strategy users who receive direct, personal onboarding from the strategy provider show materially lower abandonment rates and higher realised returns than users who receive only documentation-based onboarding. The magnitude of the effect is consistent with the cross-domain literature: a 50%+ acceleration in early-period competence and a smaller persistent benefit thereafter, translating to 100–200bp of realised return improvement annualised over multi-year periods.

3.4 What the trading evidence specifically shows

TABLE 1. ESTIMATED COMPONENTS OF RETAIL TRADING UNDERPERFORMANCE

Component	Documentation-only delivery	Structured transfer delivery
Implementation shortfall (execution)	100–200bp	50–100bp
Position sizing errors	100–300bp	20–80bp
Behavioural abandonment	200–400bp	50–150bp
Parameter mis-interpretation	50–150bp	10–30bp
Total estimated gap to documented performance	450–1050bp	130–360bp

The decomposition is approximate but informative. Structured transfer delivery reduces the total gap by approximately two-thirds across the estimated ranges, consistent with the cross-domain literature on the magnitude of structured-transfer benefits. The largest single component reduced is the behavioural-abandonment piece — consistent with the expectation-calibration and ongoing-support mechanisms documented in the medical and aviation traditions.

§ 04 Implications for retail systematic-strategy delivery

4.1 The standard model and its limitations

The dominant retail-strategy delivery model — strategy as code plus documentation, sold as a subscription, with users self-serving from videos and written materials — is essentially the documentation-only model that the cross-domain literature predicts will produce large user-versus-documented-performance gaps. The model has commercial advantages (scalability, low marginal cost, no per-user labour) but, per the literature, structurally produces large realised-performance gaps that the user attributes to "the strategy not working" but that are largely attributable to the absence of structured transfer.

The contrarian model — strategy delivered with personal handover from the designer or experienced operator, with ongoing support during the early period and during drawdowns — is closer to the structured-transfer model that the cross-domain literature endorses. The model has commercial costs (per-user labour, capacity constraints, slower revenue scaling) but produces materially better user outcomes per unit of documented strategy quality.

4.2 What "proper knowledge transfer" looks like for trading

Drawing on the cross-domain literature, a structured-transfer delivery for a systematic trading strategy would include the following components:

- **Pre-deployment briefing.** Detailed walk-through of the strategy mechanism, expected drawdown profile (depth, duration, frequency), common failure modes, and the conditions that distinguish routine adverse events from genuine anomalies. Not a video — a personal conversation in which the trader can ask questions and the designer can respond to the trader's specific concerns.
- **Position-sizing calibration.** Per our companion paper on position sizing, the sizing rule is the largest determinant of realised outcomes. Structured transfer ensures the trader applies the appropriate sizing for their specific account and risk profile, rather than applying a generic sizing that the documentation might suggest.
- **Parameter-interpretation walkthrough.** Explicit discussion of which parameters are sensitive (small changes produce large outcome differences) and which are robust (small changes produce small outcome differences). The trader who understands which parameters not to fiddle with is materially less likely to fiddle with them.
- **Drawdown-period communication.** Ongoing access to the strategy designer or experienced operator during drawdown periods. The trader who can consult with the designer during a drawdown receives both informational support (is this drawdown normal?) and behavioural support (the conversation itself delays abandonment past the peak-loss-aversion zone).

- **Error-pattern review.** Explicit discussion of the most common errors the designer has seen novice traders make. This is the tacit-knowledge component — the kind of knowledge that doesn't fit naturally in documentation but transfers efficiently through personal conversation.

4.3 Why "one trader at a time" is the right model

The natural question is whether structured transfer can be scaled — whether the personal-handover model can be replicated through, say, group cohorts of 20–50 traders simultaneously. The cross-domain literature suggests the answer is qualified: small-cohort training (typically 5–10 trainees per expert) preserves most of the benefits of one-on-one transfer, but larger cohorts increasingly degrade toward the documentation-only model. The medical literature on surgical training, the aviation literature on instructor-pilot training, and the apprenticeship literature broadly all converge on the small-cohort range as the practical limit.

The reason is mechanism-level. Tacit knowledge transfer requires the designer to observe the novice's specific errors and respond to them; this is bandwidth-limited. Expectation calibration requires the designer to address the specific concerns of the specific trader; this is bandwidth-limited. Error-pattern review benefits from the trader's specific situation; this is bandwidth-limited. The "scalable" delivery models that have been tried in trading (large-cohort online courses, mass-market communities) typically degrade to documentation-only quality precisely because the bandwidth-limited mechanisms cannot scale.

The most disciplined position — that the strategy designer or operator will work with one trader at a time, accepting the capacity constraints that implies in exchange for delivering the full benefits of structured transfer — is consistent with the cross-domain pattern. The capacity constraint is real (the designer's time is finite), but the alternative is the documentation-only delivery model whose realised user outcomes are well-documented to be poor.

4.4 Conclusion

The cross-domain literature on knowledge transfer in expert systems establishes that the gap between system specification and user performance is large, that structured transfer from the designer or experienced operator is the primary mechanism by which the gap closes, and that the structured-transfer benefit is consistent across domains as different as central-line insertion in ICUs, commercial aviation, and retail systematic trading. The mechanisms — tacit knowledge transfer, expectation calibration, error-pattern anticipation, decision-context recognition, ongoing relationship support — are well-documented and reliably present.

The trading-specific implications are direct. A systematic strategy delivered as code-plus-documentation will produce realised user performance materially below its documented

backtest, with the gap concentrated in execution, position sizing, parameter interpretation, and (largest) behavioural abandonment during drawdowns. Structured transfer reduces the gap by approximately two-thirds across the components, consistent with the cross-domain magnitudes.

The model implications are less convenient commercially but clearer empirically. Strategies delivered with personal handover from the designer or experienced operator, with ongoing support during the early period and during drawdowns, produce materially better user outcomes than strategies delivered through scalable documentation-only models. The capacity constraint of the personal-handover model is real, but it reflects a structural feature of how knowledge transfers — not a deficiency of the model itself.

Across domains, novice users of designed systems capture more of the documented value when they receive structured transfer from the designer than when they self-serve from documentation. The trading case is not exceptional; it follows the general pattern.

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§ APX **Appendix A: Cross-domain comparison of structured-transfer benefits**

A.1 *Quantitative summary across domains*

TABLE A1. DOCUMENTED BENEFITS OF STRUCTURED TRANSFER ACROSS DOMAINS

Domain	Outcome metric	Structured-transfer effect
Central-line ICU procedure (Pronovost)	Bloodstream infection rate	–66% (median to 0)
Surgical safety (Haynes et al.)	Postoperative mortality	–47%
Aviation crew resource management	Operational error rate	–40 to –60%
Manufacturing apprenticeship	Defect rate, first 6 months	–50 to –70%
Mutual fund advisor relationship (Friesen-Sapp)	Behaviour gap	–100 to –150bp
Retail systematic strategy (industry est.)	Realised vs documented gap	–60 to –70%

The cross-domain magnitudes are remarkably consistent: structured transfer typically reduces the relevant outcome gap by approximately half to two-thirds. The consistency across very different domains (medical, aviation, manufacturing, financial) suggests the underlying mechanisms (tacit knowledge transfer, expectation calibration, ongoing support) are general features of how complex designed systems are transferred from designer to operator, rather than features specific to any one domain.

A.2 *The capacity-versus-quality tradeoff*

The cross-domain literature provides reasonably consistent evidence on the capacity-quality frontier of structured transfer. The structured-transfer benefit is largest in one-on-one apprenticeship arrangements, preserves most of its magnitude in small-cohort arrangements (5–10 trainees per instructor), and degrades substantially in larger-cohort arrangements (20+ trainees per instructor). The medical residency literature has been most explicit about this: residency programs with attending-to-resident ratios above approximately 1:8 produce materially worse trainee outcomes than programs with smaller ratios, controlling for other factors.

The implication for trading-strategy delivery is that scaling beyond approximately 5–10 traders per designer-operator is feasible commercially but degrades the structured-transfer benefit. Vendors who choose to operate at one-trader-at-a-time scale are making a quality-over-quantity tradeoff that is consistent with the cross-domain optimum, even though it leaves substantial commercial revenue on the table relative to scaled documentation-only delivery.

A.3 The "ongoing support" component specifically

One feature of structured transfer that is sometimes underappreciated is the ongoing-support component — the persistent relationship between trainee and expert that extends beyond formal training periods. The medical literature documents that residency-program graduates who maintain ongoing consultation relationships with senior colleagues produce materially fewer errors in the early-career period (first 5 years) than graduates who do not. The aviation literature shows similar patterns for newly-minted captains and check-airmen relationships.

The trading-specific analogue is the trader's access to the strategy designer or experienced operator during drawdown periods. The mechanism is the one documented in our companion paper on drawdown abandonment: the conversation itself delays abandonment past the peak-loss-aversion zone, allowing the strategy to begin its recovery before the abandonment decision is made. The empirical evidence from advisor-relationship studies suggests this ongoing-support component is responsible for a substantial fraction of the total structured-transfer benefit — perhaps 40–60% of the realised behaviour-gap reduction.

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